GrayCo Construction Services

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Before You Hire a Contractor

The questions to ask, what a good estimate includes, and the red flags to walk away from.

Ask every contractor

- ☐ Are you licensed in Tennessee? (Look the license up with the TN Board for Licensing Contractors.)
- ☐ Can I see your certificate of general liability insurance — and workers' comp?
- ☐ Who will be on site, and who is my one point of contact?
- ☐ How will you keep me updated during the job?
- ☐ What is your warranty — in writing — on labor and materials?
- ☐ Can I talk to two or three recent customers?

A good estimate includes

- ☐ A written scope: exactly what will be done, room by room or area by area.
- ☐ Materials: brand, product line and color where it matters.
- ☐ Price, payment schedule and what is not included.
- ☐ Permits and inspections: who pulls them.
- ☐ Start date, expected length, and how weather delays are handled.
- ☐ Clean-up and disposal.

How payments should work

- ☐ A reasonable deposit, then payments tied to finished stages of work.
- ☐ The final payment after the final walkthrough and punch list.
- ☐ Every change agreed in writing — a signed change order — before the extra work starts.

Red flags — walk away

- ☐ Pressure to sign today, or a "today only" price.
- ☐ No written contract, or cash only.
- ☐ Large payment up front before any work or materials.

- [ ] No license, no insurance certificate, no local address.
- [ ] Offers to waive or "cover" your insurance deductible.

> **How GrayCo works:** a free estimate with a clear written scope, every selection and change approved in your own online portal, photos of the job as it goes, and a written warranty — 5 years on roofing and insurance work, 1 year on other work.

General guidance only — every home, policy and situation is different. Your insurance company decides what is covered; read your policy and ask your agent. GrayCo Construction Services is a licensed Tennessee general contractor (#85034 BCB). Warranty: 5 years on roofing and insurance work, 1 year on other work. Questions? Call (901) 585-0944.